

revolutionised digital payments in India, and its expansion into cross-border transactions presents a transformative opportunity to reshape global remittances and merchant payments.”

Rajan adds that since 2022, UPI Global has made measurable diplomatic and commercial inroads. “These aren’t just pilot projects—they’re state-backed collaborations endorsed at the level of central banks.”

UPI FOR THE WORLD

As UPI expands internationally, it has diversified its offerings to address different user segments. For example, UPI Global allows Indian users to make seamless payments at select overseas merchant outlets using QR codes.

These payments are processed in rupees, with the app handling the currency conversion.

However, its reach is limited currently, says Rohit Chhibbar, Chief Business Officer, Credit Cards at Paisabazaar. “UPI is currently accepted in a few countries. However, even in these regions, usage is limited to select merchants who have partnered with UPI-enabled apps or networks.”

To use UPI internationally, you must first activate ‘UPI International’ for your bank account under the Payment Settings of your preferred UPI app. Note that payments will be deducted in Indian rupee (INR), and foreign exchange conversion rates will apply.

Additionally, your bank may charge an international transaction fee, which may vary based on the transaction amount and destination currency.

Similarly, UPI for NRIs now supports NRE/NRO accounts and international mobile numbers. This

THE FAVOURED MODE OF TRANSACTION

• In May 2025, UPI processed over 18 billion transactions, outpacing debit and credit card volumes

MONTH	VOLUME (IN BILLION)	AVG. DAILY VOLUME (IN MILLION)
Jan '25	17	548.3
Feb '25	16.1	575.2
Mar '25	18.3	590.4
Apr '25	17.9	596.5
May '25	18.6	602.5
June '25*	7.5	632.2

NOTE *DATA AS OF JUNE 12, 2025 SOURCE NPCI

HOW INDIA PAYS

• UPI is setting global benchmarks in seamless, secure, real-time payments systems

MODE OF PAYMENT	VOLUME (MILLION)			
	FY25	2024 APRIL	2025 MARCH	2025 APRIL
UPI	185,866	13,304	18,301	17,893
NEFT	9,620	704	901	769
IMPS	5,625	550	462	449
Credit Cards	4,774	344	459	450
Debit Cards	1,612	152	120	117

SOURCE RBI

• UPI processed an impressive ₹24 lakh crore worth of transactions in April 2025, a 22% YoY growth

MODE OF PAYMENT	VALUE (₹ CRORE)			
	FY25	2024 APRIL	2025 MARCH	2025 APRIL
NEFT	443,61,464	31,30,549	48,54,308	38,97,348
UPI	260,56,955	19,64,465	24,77,222	23,94,926
IMPS	71,39,110	5,92,279	6,67,813	6,21,666
Credit Cards	21,09,197	1,56,498	2,01,494	1,84,237
Debit Cards	4,95,914	43,911	39,055	38,113

SOURCE RBI